

SMART SOCIAL PROTECTION SYSTEMS FOR THE AGE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

1 – 26 JUNE 2026

ONLINE (E-CAMPUS): 1 – 19 JUNE 2026

TURIN, ITALY: 22 – 26 JUNE 2026



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Course overview and the six pillars of Digital
Governance



AI HUB



Elements of this session

PowerPoint-Presentation

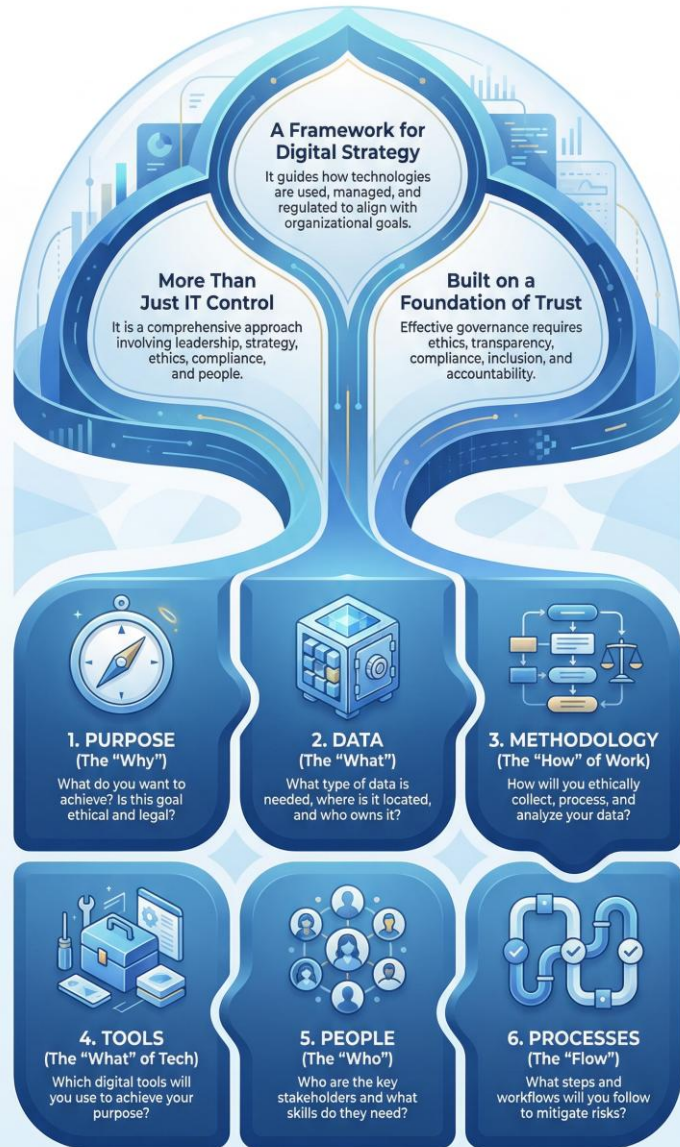
Voluntary
activities outside
the session

Activities by the
participants during the
session

Question and answers

Erstellt mit KI-Gemini

THE ESSENTIALS OF DIGITAL GOVERNANCE



The six pillars of Digital Governance

Purpose: Why

Data: What

Methodology: How(work)

Tools: What (Tech)

People: Who

Process: Flow

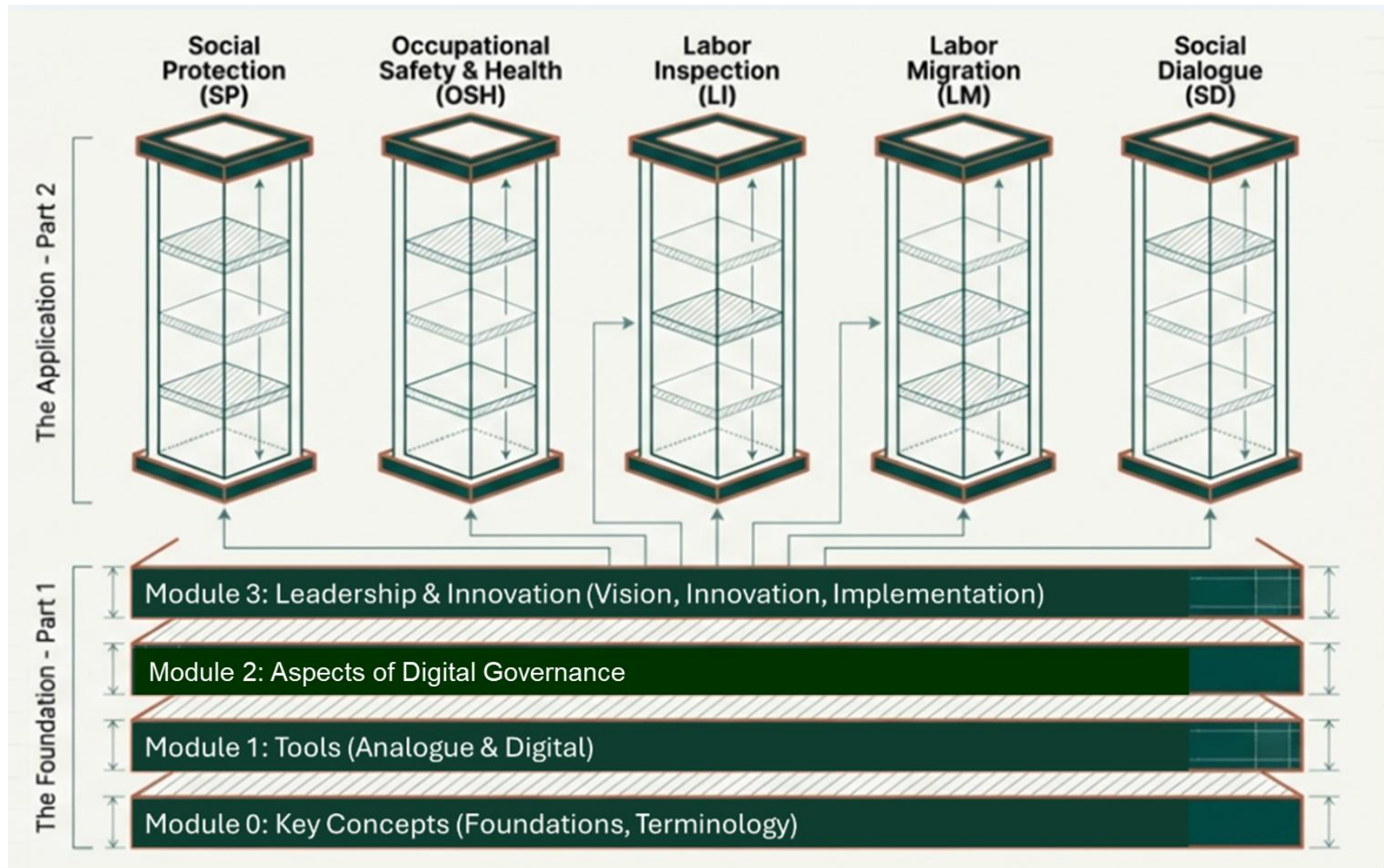
Governance in the Digital Age

A Comprehensive Definition & Framework



Digital governance is not just IT control; it is the comprehensive approach guiding how technology is managed, regulated, and aligned with societal goals. To be effective, you must govern each of these six elements individually and as a unified whole.

The Modular Learning Journey



The Modular Learning Journey



Context: These transversal modules prepare participants to apply principles to specialized fields like Social Protection, OSH, and Labor Inspection.

Module 0: Key concepts

Key Concepts for Understanding Digital Transformation



Cloud Computing

Renting space and power instead of owning servers.
Models include IaaS (Infrastructure), PaaS (Platform), and SaaS (Software).
Types: Public, Private, Hybrid, GovCloud.



IoT (Internet of Things)

Sensors + Connectivity + Processing.
Real-time data gathering for safety (e.g., smart helmets) and service delivery.



Artificial Intelligence (AI)

Machine Learning (ML): Learning from patterns.
Deep Learning: Neural networks for complex tasks.
Generative AI: Creating new content (text, images).



Big Data (The 5 Vs)

Volume, Velocity, Variety, Veracity, and Value.



Interoperability

The critical ability of systems to communicate (breaking data silos), exemplified by frameworks like Estonia's X-Road.

Module 0: Key concepts



Trust & Ethics

The moral compass of governance.

- Avoiding algorithmic bias in hiring or benefits.
- Ensuring transparency in decision-making.
- Maintaining public legitimacy.



Inclusion

Designing for all.

- Preventing the reinforcement of social inequalities.
- Addressing the digital divide at the design stage.



Cybersecurity

A culture, not just a fix.

- Threats: Phishing, Malware, Ransomware, Social Engineering.
- Defense: Awareness training, Risk Management, Privacy Compliance (GDPR).

“Without trust, a digital system, no matter how advanced, will not be widely adopted.”

Module 1: Tools

Analogue Tools



Human-centric methods for qualitative insights.

- Interviews & Workshops
- Focus Groups
- Manual Mapping

Digital Tools



Tech-centric methods for efficiency and scale.

- Case Management Systems (CMS)
- Workflow Automation (RPA)
- AI & Data Dashboards

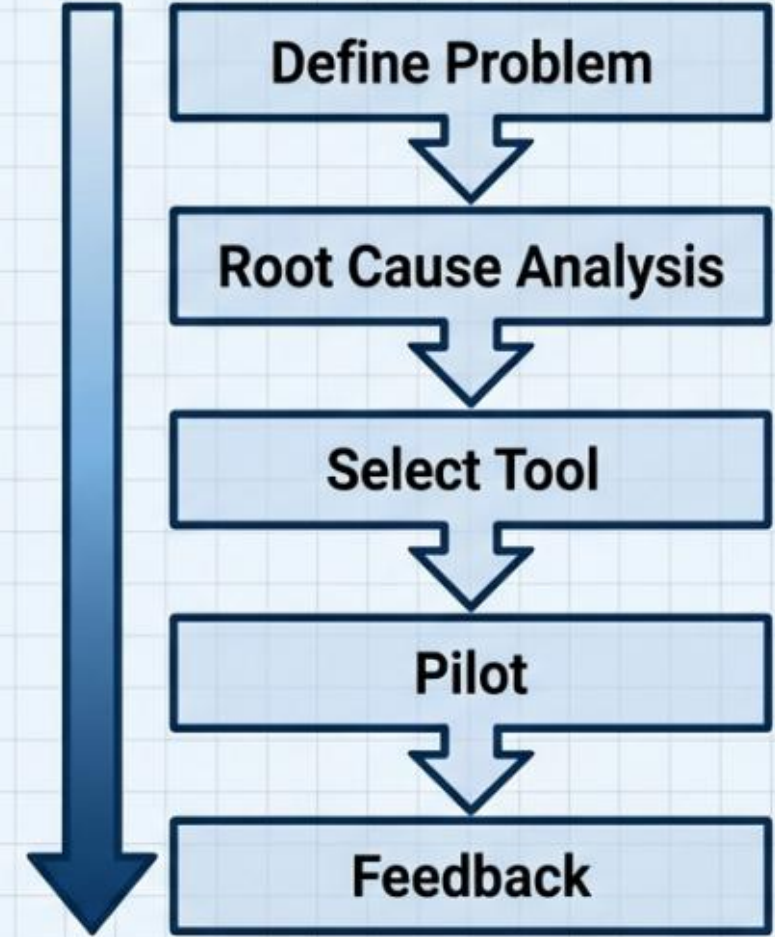
Sourcing Models

Open Source (Transparent, Community-driven) vs.
Closed Source (Proprietary, Vendor-managed).
Always consider Total Cost of Ownership (TCO).

Module 1: Tools

Evaluation Checklist

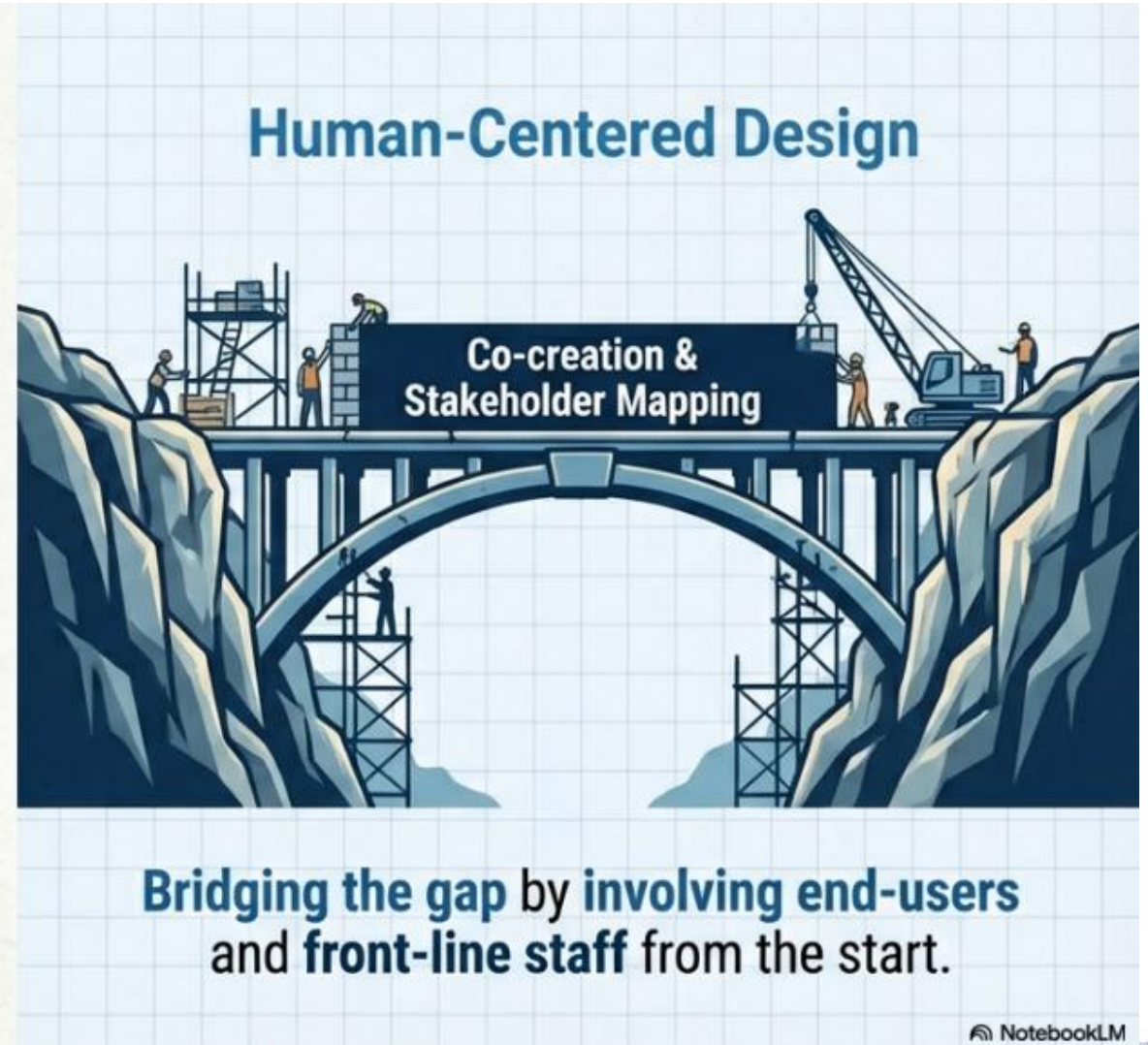
- ✓ **Goal-Oriented:** Does it solve the root cause?
- ✓ **Secure:** Does it have robust data protection?
- ✓ **Ethical:** Does it avoid bias? Is it transparent?
- ✓ **User-Friendly:** Is it accessible for low digital literacy?
- ✓ **Sustainable:** Is it interoperable? Vendor reliable?
- ✓ **Affordable:** Does budget cover full TCO?
- ✓ **Green:** Environmental impact considered?



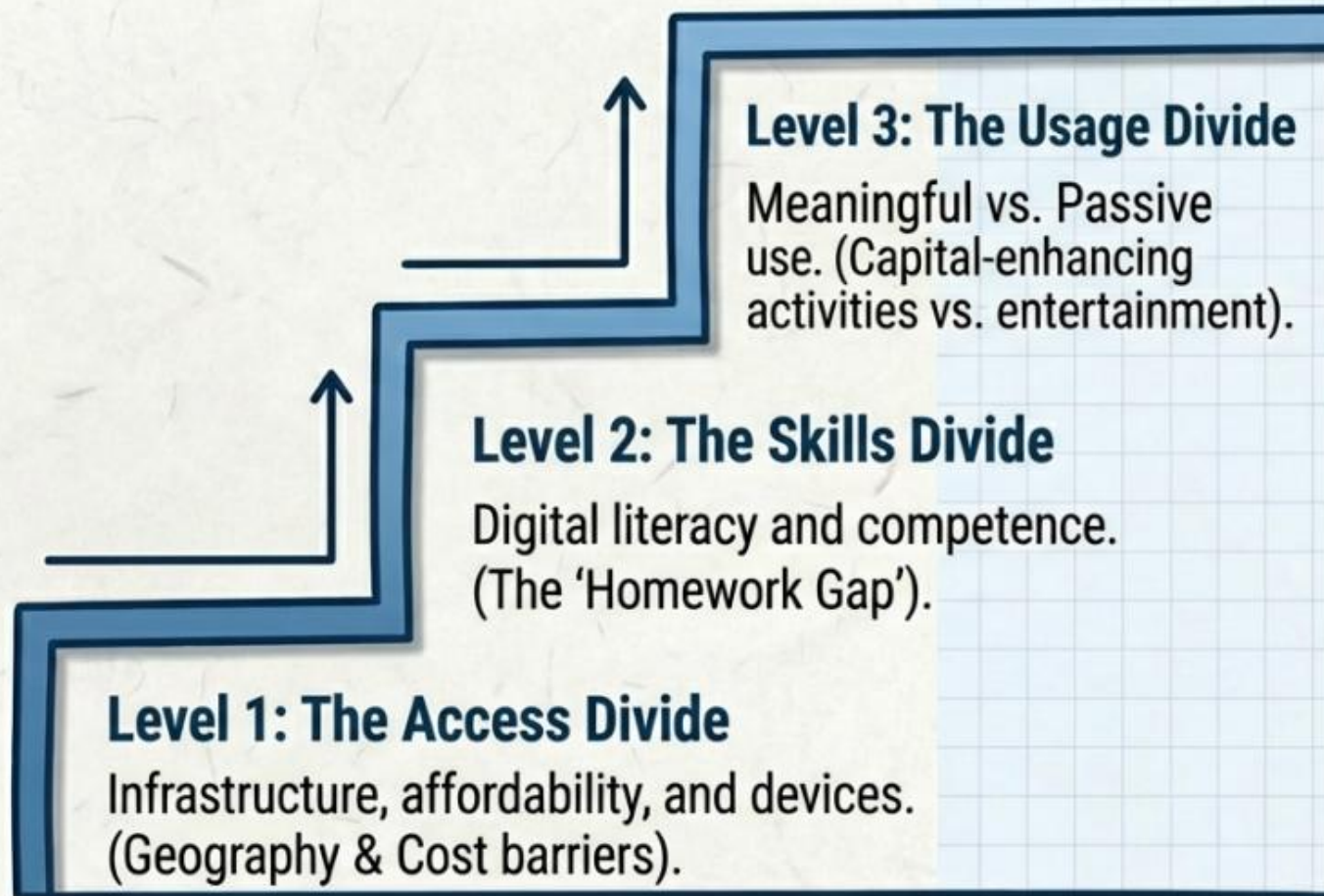
Module 2: Communication & Engagement

Communication Breakdowns

- ⚠ **Semantic:** Different definitions (e.g., 'vulnerable').
- ⚠ **Syntactic:** Incompatible formats or files.
- ⚠ **Pragmatic:** Context mismatch (wrong info for audience).
- ⚠ **Interpersonal:** Lack of trust or collaboration.



Module 2: Bridging the Digital Divide



Strategy: Digital governance must actively design for the most vulnerable (e.g., migrant workers, elderly) to avoid avoid systemic exclusion.

Module 2: The Modular Learning Journey

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

- ⚠ **Service Delivery** (Speed, Satisfaction)
- ⚠ **Efficiency** (Cost, Time)
- ⚠ **Inclusion** (User demographics)
- ⚠ **Transparency** (Data access)



Adaptive Governance: Moving from 'one-and-done' launches to continuous learning.

Module 3: Leadership



The Leader's Role

Vision-setting. Connecting digital tools to the mission.
Communicating with yourself first to understand personal fears.



Culture Building

Driving a Digital Mindset.
Celebrating small wins.
Viewing tools as opportunities, not threats.



Empowerment

Digital Champions.
Empowering peers for horizontal knowledge sharing and support.

Module 3: Leadership. Innovation and Ethics



Key Question: Whose values am I designing for?

- Algorithmic Bias (Fairness in automated decisions)
- Cultural Sensitivity (Respecting privacy norms)

